Ary Rabelo

Senior Ruby on Rails & Full-Stack Engineer | Tech Leadership, Production Ownership & AI Tooling

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About

Self-taught software engineer with 20+ years of experience, specializing in Ruby on Rails since 2012 and working remotely with US startups since 2019 (Rails, GraphQL, React, TypeScript, PostgreSQL). Experienced across cloud and production infrastructure- AWS (EC2, S3, CloudFront), Cloudflare (end-to-end type-safe TypeScript services and edge infrastructure), Heroku, Docker, Kamal, and CI/CD pipelines (GitHub Actions, CircleCI) - and I own what I ship, from on-call to observability (Sentry, New Relic, PagerDuty).

I have led teams since early in my career: as CTO of Soprojetos and, in 2026, as tech lead of a five-person development team on a six-month applied research project at UFOPA's Embrapii unit, building an AI mobile app. At every company since 2019, I have also written the technical specifications and task breakdowns. Alongside Rails, I build AI features and developer tooling, integrating language models into real products with human-confirmation guardrails and browser-based CI evaluation.

Core Skills

- **Backend & Languages:** Ruby on Rails, Ruby, Sorbet, TypeScript (end-to-end type-safe), JavaScript, SQL, Rust (itaruby), Python
- **Frontend:** React, TypeScript, GraphQL (Apollo, Relay), REST, Hotwire (Turbo, Stimulus), Vue 3
- **Databases & Search:** PostgreSQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, MySQL
- **Cloud, Infrastructure & CI/CD:** AWS (EC2, S3, CloudFront), Cloudflare (Workers/edge, serverless TypeScript infrastructure), Heroku, Docker, Kamal, DigitalOcean (Dokku), GitHub Actions, CircleCI
- **Observability & Analytics:** Sentry, New Relic, Honeybadger, PagerDuty, Mixpanel, PostHog
- **Testing & Quality:** RSpec, Capybara, Playwright, Cypress, Jest, MiniTest, TDD/BDD
- **AI & Developer Tooling:** Claude Code and coding agents, LLM product integrations, MCP servers and CLIs

Work History

May 2026 - Dec 2026

External Researcher and Tech Lead

UFOPA, Embrapii Bioforest Unit | *Six-month applied R&D research grant; Embrapii is Brazil's industrial R&D network*

- **Tech lead of a five-person development team** on doaudio, an AI app I built that records, transcribes, and summarizes Brazilian Portuguese audio: defined the architecture, broke down the work, and reviewed the pull requests on an end-to-end type-safe TypeScript stack on Cloudflare Workers.
- **15 releases shipped with the team** (May-Oct 2026): real-time notes with AI summaries, minutes and tasks; team task lists and shared project folders; RevenueCat subscriptions and paywall; a referral program; a redesigned onboarding; and a browser extension.
- Admitted by an exceptional rector's authorization as the unit's only external researcher, to continue doaudio after its March 2026 App Store and Google Play launch (the commercial app did not take off). Technical work complete; the project closes officially in December 2026.

Mar 2024 - May 2026

Senior Full Stack Software Engineer II

Canix | *All-in-one seed-to-sale ERP for cannabis cultivators, distributors and manufacturers; multi-tenant Rails, GraphQL, TypeScript and React*

Role eliminated as the engineering team was downsized (the CTO and other engineers also left).

- **CI from ~30 to ~6 minutes and 30% lower infrastructure costs:** the suite was flaky and the team had stopped trusting it. I led the Cypress to Playwright migration in small reversible PRs and made the tests deterministic (stable selectors, order-independent specs, video recordings on failure).
- **1,942 files migrated from Relay to Apollo Client** after two earlier attempts by previous teams had been reverted: changed every file deterministically with codemods, used AI agents to check each changed file and add test coverage, and shipped behind a feature flag with the tests passing before merge and a rollback ready.
- **Packages screen load from ~12 s to ~2 s** by eliminating N+1 queries with batch loaders, adding targeted indexes, and moving heavy reports to background jobs.
- **Resolved a production incident** where an oversized Metrc sync batch blocked the Sidekiq queue and scheduled syncs began overlapping: paused the queue, isolated the job in its own queue, added retry limits and idempotency, then fixed the root cause.
- Built UAT-Agent, an AI QA step in CI: on every pull request it opens the preview app like a real user, reads the acceptance criteria with Claude Code, validates them, and records a highlight video for PMs and engineers.
- Built compliance integrations with Metrc, Biotrack, LeafLink, and QuickBooks Online with the team, working in a Sorbet-typed Rails codebase.

2020 - Feb 2024

Senior Full Stack Software Engineer

Flowspace | *YC-backed on-demand warehousing and fulfillment for Fortune 500 brands and e-commerce startups; Rails monolith, GraphQL API, React and TypeScript*

- Built the **AI Command Center** as a founding contributor: an in-app chat where an LLM searches orders and inventory, adjusts stock, and generates tags, with mandatory user confirmation before executing any database change.
- **Removed manual data entry for freight documents:** built an inbound mailbox where merchants emailed Bills of Lading directly, and the system automatically matched orders, parsed documents, and notified ops on Slack.
- Built the DoorDash same-day delivery integration with the team, from merchant terms of service to warehouse dispatch flows.
- **Support stopped needing engineering for routine issues** after I built ActiveAdmin tools for the most common escalations.
- Took part in the production on-call rotation, introduced ViewComponents to speed up template testing, and mentored new engineers in an async remote team.

2019 - 2020

Full Stack Engineer

Cleary | *Employee experience platform founded by two ex-Twitter employees; clients included JUUL, Flexport, and Armory*

Rails API with a React and TypeScript frontend on AWS, with GitHub and CircleCI CI/CD pipelines.

- **60% faster article creation** without background workers (a strict product requirement).
- Built and maintained HRIS integrations with Workday and Namely.
- Migrated 500+ pages to the Froala editor while preserving previous layouts, and built a reusable React comment architecture.

2016 - 2019

Full Stack Developer

Monde Sistemas | *Multi-tenant platform for 1,700+ travel agencies*

- **26,000+ MiniTest tests migrated to RSpec in one week.**
- **90% faster selected SQL queries** using full-text search.
- Shipped daily with 100% test coverage (RSpec, Capybara, code review).

2003 - 2017

Earlier career

- **Soprojetos**, CTO and Rails developer (2003 - 2016, modernization 2026): an architecture-plans e-commerce store I started with my parents, built from scratch in PHP and then Ruby on Rails, leading a team of up to 7. Built an automated digital project delivery pipeline on **AWS (S3 + CloudFront)**, Rails, and Redis, plus faceted search with **Elasticsearch**, and **scaled to 1.8M monthly visits (peaks of 3M) and 300+ req/s on a single 2 GB Heroku dyno**. In 2026, spent roughly six weeks modernizing it to current Rails, Hotwire (Turbo & Stimulus), Docker and Kamal container deploys.
- **DescontosHoje**, founder (2017): coupon mobile app in React Native (Expo) backed by a Ruby on Rails API on DigitalOcean with Dokku and CircleCI, built with a friend to learn the stack. Shipped to the App Store and Google Play and reached **5,000+ downloads and 60+ merchant trials in month one**, but did not take off.

Open Source Contributions

- **30 merged pull requests** to open source repositories since May 2026: 6 crash fixes in Discourse (one in the AI bot retry handler), 3 dead-code removals in Rails plus a fix a Rails maintainer landed with me as co-author, a fastlane fix, Archon, beads, an offline test suite for SerpApi's official MCP server, and 15 in software-factory, where I added Ruby support.
- Built itaruby, a Ruby type checker in Rust (MIT, alpha) that infers types instead of requiring annotations; I only submitted candidate diagnostics after reproducing each error under MRI with the project's own test suite.
- Built **RepoDocs**, a zero-dependency Python CLI published on PyPI that drives Claude Code, OMP, or Codex CLI to generate a source-cited wiki for any repository: every claim links to an exact file and line, pages build in parallel with SHA-256 incremental rebuilds, and a citation lint checks the output.
- Wrote the **NEXT ACTION protocol**, a drop-in instruction for coding agents (Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, Gemini CLI) that makes every response end in exactly one unambiguous next step: done, a decision for the human, a human-only step, or a wait on something external.
- Published **Tapa**, a Rust and Tauri Markdown editor that coding agents can inspect and edit over MCP, and **serpapi-agent-toolkit** (plus searchapi-agent-toolkit, planqueue, and omp-burnrate), TypeScript CLIs for coding agents; serpapi-agent-toolkit uses **~17x fewer tokens per call** than the official MCP server.

Education

2016 - 2018

Master's in Process Engineering

PPGEP / UFPA | *Thesis: applied artificial neural networks (Python, Keras) to identify sales opportunities in marketing data*

Community & Mentoring

Help run a community of 150+ IT students in Santarém, mentor early-career programmers, and speak a couple of times a year at regional universities about software engineering, remote work culture, and AI.